

Influence_Consensus_agr_hom - In society, at the population level, does Agriculture alone generally have a direct effect on Homelessness, or are observed relationships primarily indirect? This is a macro level analysis, including all of society, not just agrarian or farming populations. If a direct effect exists, is it negative, none, negligible, or positive? What would be a reasonable normalized magnitude for this influence on a scale from -1.00 to 1.00? Please only provide evidence for only direct influences

Agriculture and Homelessness: Evidence on Direct Macro-Level Effects

The available research focuses on how **rural areas and rural employment (including agriculture-related work)** might be used to reduce homelessness in the United States, not on agriculture as an isolated causal factor. It examines geographic area type (rural/suburban/urban/major city), unemployment, and homelessness counts.

Conceptual Link: Agriculture vs. Rural Context

- The paper treats **rural areas (where agriculture is more prevalent)** as a potential lever to alleviate homelessness via lower housing costs and job opportunities, but it does **not isolate agriculture itself** as an independent variable (Adekanbi, 2024).
- Recommended strategies include creating jobs “within and outside the agricultural industry” in rural areas, but agriculture is just one part of a broader rural employment package (Adekanbi, 2024).

Quantitative Evidence on Direct Effects

- The formal regression and ANCOVA models use:
 - Dependent variable: overall homelessness.
 - Predictors: **urban CoC dummy, rural CoC dummy, and average unemployment rate; no agricultural sector or employment variable is included** (Adekanbi, 2024).
- Results:
 - Urban classification is associated with higher homelessness, rural classification with lower homelessness (Adekanbi, 2024).
 - Unemployment has a positive effect on homelessness in regression but is not significant in ANCOVA (Adekanbi, 2024).
- Because **no direct measure of agriculture** (e.g., agricultural employment share, output, or land use) is modeled, **no direct causal effect of “agriculture alone” on homelessness is estimated.**

Geographic Category and Homelessness

Factor modeled	Direction of effect on homelessness	Citations
Urban CoC	Increases homelessness	(Adekanbi, 2024)
Rural CoC	Decreases homelessness	(Adekanbi, 2024)

Factor modeled	Direction of effect on homelessness	Citations
Agriculture	Not directly modeled	(Adekanbi, 2024)

FIGURE 1 Area type affects homelessness; agriculture unmeasured

Interpreting Magnitude and Sign

The study reports partial eta-squared around **0.32–0.33** for “area category” and $R^2 \approx 0.28$, but this reflects **rural/urban classification**, not agriculture itself (Adekanbi, 2024). Since agriculture is never entered as a separate predictor, **no normalized magnitude (–1.00 to 1.00) can be assigned for agriculture’s direct influence** from this evidence.

Conclusion

Within the provided research, agriculture is only discussed as a component of broader rural employment strategies. The empirical models do not include agriculture as a distinct variable, so they provide **no direct, quantified evidence** that “agriculture alone” affects homelessness at the population level. Any observed relationships are through **rural vs. urban context and employment patterns**, not agriculture in isolation, and a numerical influence magnitude for agriculture cannot be derived from this paper.

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References

Adekanbi, O. (2024). LEVERAGING RURAL AREAS & EMPLOYMENT IN AGRICULTURAL & NON AGRICULTURAL SECTORS TO ERADICATE HOMELESSNESS IN USA: A STUDY OF RURAL, SUBURBAN, AND URBAN CoCs INCLUDING A MAJOR CITY CoC. *The American Journal of Social Science and Education Innovations*.
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